For the first time in contemporary Kerala's history, we witnessed crowds assembling organically, and the visuals from the Yatra moved even the typically sceptical media. Last year, the passing away of the much-loved leader Oommen Chandy evoked an emotional response from people across the political spectrum. But Kerala wouldn't have anticipated such an overwhelming reaction to a leader embarking on a walking journey. The emotions among the people, especially among Muslims, women and the youth, were truly remarkable. Everyone wanted to join in, from the younger generation to the retired individuals, men and women. They thronged the route, waving, smiling, shouting slogans and even occasionally squeezing through the crowd and security lines to get close to Rahul, to touch him, or even share a warm and reassuring hug. It's a rare leader who possesses the qualities and the willingness to be out in the open, and stand as one with the people.

As the Yatra gently but profoundly made its way into the heart of Thiruvananthapuram, a place where daily commuters often harbour disdain for processions and the inevitable traffic disruptions they bring, there was a shift in perception. The media, accustomed to directing their cameras and microphones at the frustrated and inconvenienced public, received an unexpected response. Typically, people vent their frustration at politicians and union leaders who cause these disruptive roadblocks. However, the BJY brought a different perspective. 'He is walking. Let him,' they softly uttered. This simple act of pedestrian empathy and involvement was profound. Here was a leader traversing the length of the country on foot, embarking on a pilgrimage to redeem the nation's soul. 'We can wait,' they declared, their voices echoing patience and understanding.

A Beacon of Trust: In the Footsteps of Gandhi

In Rahul Gandhi, the people saw a reflection of trustworthiness. To marginalized minorities, particularly Muslims, Rahul Gandhi embodied a figure who would stand up for them, seeking to restore the pluralistic spaces